

THE FROM RELIGIOUS DIVISION TO THE ARMADA: HOW DID ELIZABETH SECURE HER THRONE?

DOSSIER:

KEY TOPIC 1: QUEEN, GOVERNMENT AND RELIGION, 1558-69

80 Crucial Questions. Complete Knowledge Mastery.

Operative / Student Name: _____

Target: Total Recall

RESTRICTED ACCESS - MASTER YOUR MEMORY

How to Hack Your Memory

(Rules of Engagement)

1. Never Just Read

Reading the answers feels like learning, but it's an illusion. You must force your brain to struggle to find the answer. The struggle is what builds memory pathways.

2. Cover, Recall, Check

Cover the answer sheet. Write your answer down in the notes section (or say it out loud). Only then are you allowed to check 'The Vault'.

3. Track Your Threat Level

Use the R-A-G (Red, Amber, Green) checkboxes next to every question after you attempt it.

- ☐ **Green:** I nailed it instantly.
- ☐ **Amber:** I got it, but I had to think hard.
- ☐ **Red:** My mind went blank. (Revisit these tomorrow).

4. The Interrogation (Homework Protocol)

True mastery requires testing under pressure. Hand 'The Vault' (answers) to your parent or guardian. They will test you on 20 random questions. They hold the score; they hold the signature.

KT1.1: The situation on Elizabeth's accession, 1558

Q#	The Target Question	R	A	G	Notes / My Answer
1	How old was Elizabeth when she ascended to the throne in 1558?	☐	☐	☐	
2	What phrase describes the rigid social hierarchy of Elizabethan England where everyone 'knew their place'?	☐	☐	☐	
3	What percentage of the Elizabethan population lived in the countryside?	☐	☐	☐	
4	What system did the monarch use to maintain control by rewarding loyalty with land, titles, and monopolies?	☐	☐	☐	
5	Roughly how many trusted nobles and advisers made up the Privy Council?	☐	☐	☐	
6	Who was Elizabeth's most important minister and Secretary of State?	☐	☐	☐	
7	How many times was Parliament called during Elizabeth's entire reign?	☐	☐	☐	
8	Why did the Pope view Elizabeth as illegitimate?	☐	☐	☐	
9	What term was used to describe a female ruler with actual power, rather than just a figurehead?	☐	☐	☐	
10	Why was Elizabeth reluctant to marry?	☐	☐	☐	
11	How much debt did Elizabeth inherit in 1558?	☐	☐	☐	
12	What was the Crown's annual revenue when Elizabeth became queen?	☐	☐	☐	
13	How much money was owed to the Antwerp Exchange?	☐	☐	☐	

Q#	The Target Question	R	A	G	Notes / My Answer
14	What interest rate did the foreign moneylenders at the Antwerp Exchange charge?	☐	☐	☐	
15	What economic process implemented by previous monarchs caused massive inflation?	☐	☐	☐	
16	How did Elizabeth remarkably clear the Crown's debt by 1574?	☐	☐	☐	
17	What 1559 treaty ended the war with France and surrendered Calais?	☐	☐	☐	
18	What was the name of the traditional alliance between France and Scotland?	☐	☐	☐	
19	Which Catholic monarch had a strong claim to the English throne and was married to the French heir?	☐	☐	☐	
20	What 1564 treaty did Elizabeth sign to avoid further war with France by permanently recognising their claim to Calais?	☐	☐	☐	

MISSION DEBRIEF

Score: _____ / 20

Parent/Guardian Authentication (Signature): _____

Date: _____

KT1.2: The 'settlement' of religion, 1559

Q#	The Target Question	R	A	G	Notes / My Answer
21	What year did Elizabeth introduce her Religious Settlement?	☐	☐	☐	
22	What term is used to describe Elizabeth's political compromise to satisfy both Protestants and Catholics?	☐	☐	☐	
23	Which specific Act made Elizabeth the 'Supreme Governor' rather than the 'Supreme Head' of the Church?	☐	☐	☐	
24	Which Act dictated that the English Book of Common Prayer must be used in all churches?	☐	☐	☐	
25	What were the strict instructions issued by William Cecil detailing exactly how to worship and govern the Church called?	☐	☐	☐	
26	Aside from religious services, name one crucial social function of the parish church.	☐	☐	☐	
27	What specific legal system did the Church run to handle moral crimes, marriage, slander, and wills?	☐	☐	☐	
28	What term describes the official inspections carried out by bishops every three to four years to check on the clergy?	☐	☐	☐	
29	Who were the radical Protestants that wanted to eradicate all Catholic "superstitions" from the Church?	☐	☐	☐	
30	Which Catholic item did Puritans demand be removed from churches, leading to a major controversy where Elizabeth backed down?	☐	☐	☐	

Q#	The Target Question	R	A	G	Notes / My Answer
31	What was the name of the document issued by the Archbishop of Canterbury in 1566 to enforce traditional clerical robes?	☐	☐	☐	
32	How many Puritan priests in London were dismissed for refusing to wear the mandated vestments?	☐	☐	☐	
33	What term describes Catholics who actively refused to attend the new Protestant Church services?	☐	☐	☐	
34	In what year did the Pope explicitly order English Catholics not to attend the new Church of England services?	☐	☐	☐	
35	Why did Elizabeth initially instruct authorities to turn a blind eye to minor Catholic disobedience?	☐	☐	☐	
36	Which Catholic figurehead arrived in England in 1568, giving disgruntled Catholics a legitimate rival to rally around?	☐	☐	☐	
37	What severe action did the Pope take against Elizabeth in 1570?	☐	☐	☐	
38	How did the 1570 excommunication change the behaviour of English Catholics?	☐	☐	☐	
39	Which two Catholic superpowers were officially encouraged by the Pope to sponsor plots against Elizabeth?	☐	☐	☐	
40	Why was the Catholic challenge ultimately more dangerous to Elizabeth than the Puritan challenge?	☐	☐	☐	

MISSION DEBRIEF

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KT1.3: Challenge to the religious settlement

Q#	The Target Question	R	A	G	Notes / My Answer
41	What was the main objection of the Puritans regarding the 1559 Religious Settlement?	☐	☐	☐	
42	What objects did Puritans demand be removed from churches because they viewed them as superstitious idols?	☐	☐	☐	
43	Why did Elizabeth back down during the Crucifix Controversy?	☐	☐	☐	
44	What controversy in 1566 involved Puritans refusing to wear special clerical robes (surplices)?	☐	☐	☐	
45	What was the name of the guidelines issued by the Archbishop of Canterbury in 1566 to enforce priestly clothing?	☐	☐	☐	
46	How many London priests were dismissed for refusing to wear the mandated vestments?	☐	☐	☐	
47	Who was the ultimate authority for Catholics, making their loyalty to Elizabeth suspect?	☐	☐	☐	
48	What term describes Catholics who actively refused to attend the new Protestant Church of England services?	☐	☐	☐	
49	In which region of England was traditional Catholic support and noble resistance the strongest?	☐	☐	☐	
50	Why did Elizabeth initially avoid strictly enforcing recusancy fines against Catholics?	☐	☐	☐	
51	What major domestic Catholic rebellion occurred in 1569?	☐	☐	☐	
52	What was the Catholic Church's Europe-wide campaign to	☐	☐	☐	

Q#	The Target Question	R	A	G	Notes / My Answer
	reverse the Protestant Reformation called?				
53	What instruction did the Pope give to English Catholics in 1566?	☐	☐	☐	
54	What catastrophic action did Pope Pius V take against Elizabeth in 1570?	☐	☐	☐	
55	What did the 1570 Papal Bull explicitly tell English Catholics?	☐	☐	☐	
56	Which Catholic figurehead fled to England in 1568, becoming the focus of plots against Elizabeth?	☐	☐	☐	
57	Which two major European superpowers posed a direct military threat to Protestant England?	☐	☐	☐	
58	Where was the Catholic seminary located that trained priests to be secretly sent into England?	☐	☐	☐	
59	Name one prominent Puritan leader who actively opposed the Elizabethan settlement.	☐	☐	☐	
60	Why was the Catholic challenge considered vastly more dangerous than the Puritan challenge?	☐	☐	☐	

MISSION DEBRIEF

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KT1.4: The problem of Mary, Queen of Scots

Q#	The Target Question	R	A	G	Notes / My Answer
61	How was Mary, Queen of Scots related to Elizabeth I?	☐	☐	☐	
62	From which English King did Mary derive her claim to the throne?	☐	☐	☐	
63	Why did many Catholics believe Elizabeth was illegitimate?	☐	☐	☐	
64	Which country was Mary briefly the Queen of before returning to Scotland?	☐	☐	☐	
65	What was the name of Mary's second husband, who was murdered in 1567?	☐	☐	☐	
66	Who was the prime suspect in the murder, whom Mary subsequently married?	☐	☐	☐	
67	What did the Scottish Protestant lords force Mary to do after capturing her in 1567?	☐	☐	☐	
68	In whose favour was Mary forced to abdicate?	☐	☐	☐	
69	In what year did Mary flee Scotland and arrive in England?	☐	☐	☐	
70	Why did Elizabeth refuse to help Mary regain her throne by force?	☐	☐	☐	
71	Why was Elizabeth reluctant to hand Mary over to the Scottish lords for punishment?	☐	☐	☐	
72	Why couldn't Elizabeth simply allow Mary to travel to France or Spain?	☐	☐	☐	
73	What was the name of the legal inquiry set up by Elizabeth to investigate Mary?	☐	☐	☐	
74	What evidence was produced by the Scottish lords to try and	☐	☐	☐	

Q#	The Target Question	R	A	G	Notes / My Answer
	prove Mary's guilt?				
75	What did the Casket Letters allegedly contain?	☐	☐	☐	
76	What was Mary's defence against the letters?	☐	☐	☐	
77	What was Elizabeth's final verdict regarding Mary's guilt?	☐	☐	☐	
78	What was the immediate outcome for Mary following the inquiry?	☐	☐	☐	
79	Why was keeping Mary in England a massive risk for Elizabeth?	☐	☐	☐	
80	What major uprising occurred in England just one year after Mary's arrival?	☐	☐	☐	

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THE VAULT

Restricted Access: Answer Keys

KT1.1: The situation on Elizabeth's accession, 1558

1. 21
2. The Great Chain of Being
3. 90%
4. Patronage
5. 19
6. William Cecil
7. Nine times
8. He refused to recognise Henry VIII's marriage to Anne Boleyn
9. Queen Regnant
10. Her husband would be expected to govern the country, reducing her power
11. £300,000
12. £286,667
13. £100,000
14. 14%
15. Debasement of the coinage
16. She cut household expenses by half and sold Crown lands
17. Treaty of Cateau-Cambrésis
18. The Auld Alliance
19. Mary, Queen of Scots
20. Peace of Troyes

KT1.2: The 'settlement' of religion, 1559

21. 1559
22. The 'Middle Way'
23. The Act of Supremacy
24. The Act of Uniformity
25. The Royal Injunctions
26. Providing charity for the poor / enforcing social control
27. Church courts
28. Visitations



- 29. Puritans
- 30. Crucifixes
- 31. The Book of Advertisements
- 32. 37
- 33. Recusants
- 34. 1566
- 35. She actively avoided creating Catholic martyrs
- 36. Mary, Queen of Scots
- 37. He excommunicated her
- 38. It absolved them of their loyalty to the Queen / weaponised them into treason
- 39. Spain and France
- 40. Catholics had the backing of foreign militaries, the Papacy, and a rival queen to replace Elizabeth

KT1.3: Challenge to the religious settlement

41. They believed it kept too many Catholic elements and wanted to 'purify' the Church
42. Crucifixes
43. Several powerful Puritan bishops threatened to resign
44. The Vestment Controversy
45. The Book of Advertisements
46. 37
47. The Pope
48. Recusants
49. The North / North-West
50. She did not want to create Catholic martyrs or provoke a rebellion
51. The Revolt of the Northern Earls
52. The Counter-Reformation
53. Not to attend Church of England services
54. He excommunicated her / issued a Papal Bull
55. That it was no longer a sin to rebel against her and they were absolved of their loyalty
56. Mary, Queen of Scots
57. Spain and France
58. Douai, in the Netherlands
59. John Foxe / Thomas Cartwright
60. Catholics had the backing of foreign military powers, the Papacy, and had Mary, Queen of Scots as an alternative monarch

KT1.4: The problem of Mary, Queen of Scots

61. She was her second cousin
62. King Henry VII
63. They did not recognise Henry VIII's divorce, meaning his marriage to Anne Boleyn was invalid
64. France
65. Lord Darnley
66. The Earl of Bothwell
67. Abdicate the throne
68. Her infant son, James VI
69. 1568
70. It would anger the friendly Protestant Scottish lords and ruin relations with Scotland

71. She believed in the Divine Right of Kings and did not want to support subjects overthrowing an anointed monarch
72. She feared Mary would raise a foreign Catholic army to invade England
73. The Conference of York / Westminster
74. The 'Casket Letters'
75. Letters and poems plotting Darnley's murder
76. She claimed they were forged and that a court couldn't try an anointed queen
77. She stated that her guilt was "not proven" / neither guilty nor innocent
78. She was kept in strict captivity in England
79. It made Mary a focal point for English Catholics and plotters to rally around
80. The Revolt of the Northern Earls in 1569

Mastery Tracker

Track your total recall score across all 80 questions.

Attempt	Date	Score (/80)	Parent/Guardian Signature	Target for Next Time
1				
2				
3				

Operative Reflection

My ultimate strength in this unit is...

The three specific facts I need to hunt down and memorize tonight are...